

VANIER COLLEGE MUSIC DEPARTMENT
Faculty of Arts, Business and Social Sciences



582 582
Intégration Multimedia
Multimédia

Sound Design for Multimedia 551-301-VA
Semester: A-26 Section(s): 1&2

Ponderation: 1-2-2**Prerequisites: 582-204-VA**

Instructor:	Dr Scott Cook	Office:	A-210
E-Mail:	cooks@vaniercollege.qc.ca	Telephone:	744-7500 ext: 7690
Office Hours:	As posted on Omnivox (and by appointment)		

Course Description: Students will use industry-standard technology necessary to produce soundtracks for multimedia, using a digital audio workstation. The students will learn the basics of acoustics, sound design and how music and soundtracks affect media.

Competency to be achieved: Students who pass this course will have partially fulfilled competency 015H (*Traiter la bande son*).

Place in the Program:

Sound Design for Multimedia builds on what was learned in Video & Audio Editing 1, focusing on sound design and editing. Students will learn more advanced audio recording and editing techniques and the role of sound in a multimedia project. This knowledge and these skills will be applied to other courses including Video & Audio Editing 2 in semester 4.

Teaching Method: Lectures/quizzes on theoretical concepts toward hands-on, experiential learning with practical exercises to develop production skills and artistic process beyond the lab.

Course Contents:

See the weekly schedule below for a complete list of topics covered.

Four projects will be assigned (including the LIA):

- A Radio Ad Assignment
- A Dialogue Recording (podcast) Assignment
- An Automated Dialogue Replacement (ADR) Assignment
- A Personal Branding Assignment

Learning Integrative Assessment (LIA): The student will produce a video or multimedia project with an impactful soundtrack (approximately 30 seconds to 3 minutes depending on the complexity of the task). The student will produce the soundtrack using materials covered throughout the term. The assessment will comprise Digital Audio Workstation (DAW) operation, equalization, digital effects, compression, editing and mixdown.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Prepare material to be recorded to ensure optimal time management.
- Correct gain structure to ensure optimal signal to noise ratio and avoidance of distortion.
- Correct track labelling and signal path routing.
- Classify sound effects and audio roles.
- Choose effect plugins and optimal adjustment of common parameters.
- Apply fades, cross-fades, splicing, and editing tools.
- Use equalization, compression, and noise reduction.
- Adjust track volume levels.
- Demonstrate standard computer key commands.

Evaluation		
Assessment	Date	Percentage
Four Quizzes (5% each)	Week 03, Week 05, Week 09, Week 11	20%
Three Projects (15% each)	Week 05-06, Week 09-10, Week 12-13	30%
Midterm Test	Week 08	15%
LIA Project	Due December 08	35%

Tentative Weekly Schedule	
Week 01	Intro: Sound, Generally Speaking
Week 02	Intro to Adobe Audition + In-Class Assignment
Week 03	Quiz #1 (pp.2-3); EQ, Compression
Week 04	Audio Effects + In-Class Assignment
Week 05	Quiz #2 (pp.10-11); Introduce Radio Ad (RA) Assignment
Week 06	Lab: RA Workshop
Week 07	<i>Tues, no class (Mon Sched); Thurs: RA Exhibit</i>
Week 08	Midterm Assessment
Week 09	Quiz #3 (pp.12-14); Introduce Podcast Assignment (PC)
Week 10	Lab: PC Workshop
Week 11	Quiz #4 (pp.8-9); PC Exhibit
Week 12	Syncing Sound to Film; Introduce ADR (ADR) Assignment
Week 13	Lab: ADR Workshop
Week 14	Introduce Branding Assignment (LIA)
Week 15	Lab: Branding Assignment (Due Dec 08)
<i>Schedule changes may occur in weeks for reasons that are beyond the music department's control.</i>	

Required Materials: Mac-compatible portable external SSD hard drive for storing assignments (example: Samsung T7 1TB or equivalent), notebook, writing implement

Course-Level Learning Outcome: Students will Design Sound for impactful video and multimedia projects.

Learning Outcomes

The students will be able to do the following:

- Apply the relevant theory behind the role of sound in video and multimedia projects
- Apply the aspects of the science of sound that are relevant to the project such as equalization, transients, dynamic range, spatialization, sample rate, bit depth, data formatting and effects.
- Create and produce a soundtrack* that communicates the intended idea or emotion
- Apply the fundamentals of how sound is produced and how it can be manipulated with digital technology (DAW) to create an audio recording.
- Use industry-standard professional audio editing software.
- Use equalization, effects, compression, and noise reduction to produce a “finalized” audio file.
- Create audio for various platforms (Spotify, YouTube, CD, Film, Television etc.)
- Use critical listening skills to produce an impactful recording, focusing on the technical aspects of sound, including attention to specific frequency ranges, dynamic range, tone, phase and relative track balances.

** Soundtrack refers to all sounds in the project.*

GENERAL COLLEGE ACADEMIC POLICIES

It is the student's responsibility to be familiar with and adhere to all Vanier College Policies. A summary of the course-level policies that apply in this and all other Vanier courses can be found under “Course-Level Policies” in **Important Vanier Links** on **Omnivox**, or by following this link: www.vaniercollege.qc.ca/bylaws-policies.

Vanier College offers support to students through Student Services in a number of ways, including: personal and career counselling, The One-Stop Service (sexual violence support), support for students with disabilities (ACCESS) and Financial Aid (Loans and Bursaries and additional resources). For more information about these and other services come to C-203 or contact intake@vaniercollege.qc.ca or see The Student Guide at <https://www.vaniercollege.qc.ca/student-guide>.

If you are in crisis or in an emergency situation, which your life or the life of someone near you is at risk, please call 911, go to the hospital nearest you, or call Suicide Prevention Centre of Montreal at 1-866-277-3553 or by text 535353.

ACADEMIC COMPLAINTS

A student with an academic complaint should first speak directly with the teacher involved to see if the matter can be resolved. If the student is not satisfied, they should contact the Department Coordinator as soon as possible who will advise them of the next steps (possible mediation or request for a grade review etc.).

The student may also consult with Student Services for additional assistance, including the student advocacy service. The student also has the right to communicate directly with the faculty dean; however, first should try to resolve the matter with the teacher and/or coordinator(s).

Music Department Coordinator, Dave Watts: wattsd@vaniercollege.qc.ca

Dean of FAABS, Alena Perout: perout@vaniercollege.qc.ca